

The message you have been putting off.

It has been on your list two days. You have opened it twice and closed it. The hard part was never the words.

THE SHIFT

You know exactly what happened and what needs to happen next. What stops you is the first sentence, because once you hit send it is a record. So here is the move. Do not ask AI to write the message. **Ask it to help you land the message.**

Name the reaction you want

This is the line people skip, and it changes everything. Now it is not writing a message, it is writing toward an outcome.

I want this family member to feel heard and to understand what we are doing about it.

Say what you cannot promise

Give it the facts, what you can commit to, and just as important, what you have no authority to offer.

Say so up front and it stops offering it.

Ask for three versions

One warm, one plain and factual, one firm. You will know within ten seconds which is right.

You probably could not have told me in advance which one you wanted.

BEFORE YOU SEND IT

Rehearse the reaction

Paste your chosen version back in and ask: read this the way somebody already angry would read it, and tell me where it lands wrong. It finds the sentence you thought was neutral.

Describe the situation, not the person

No names. Not a patient, not a staff member, not a family. It does not need who. It needs what happened.

Why this is worth the five minutes

A rehearsal of how the message will be read is not something you can get anywhere else at eleven at night.

YOUR CHALLENGE THIS WEEK

Take the one you have been avoiding. Give it four sentences of context and the reaction you want, and ask for three versions.

Then ask it how the person on the other end is going to read the one you picked.

Before you send anything, read it. You are the pilot. AI is the co-pilot. Every decision still goes through you.